

Midterm Oral Exam

JS-310 | The Eastern European Jewish Experience through Literature and Film

Instructor: Andrzej Brylak / Yulia Dubasova

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight: 20%

Group project: No

Overview (Grading breakdown)

Midterm Quiz 15

Assignment Description

During the 8th instructional week, each student will deliver a 15-minute oral presentation on a quote from any of the readings covered so far. The presentation has to cover: 1. A thesis: what do you want to prove by selecting the quote? 2. Formal literary devices, in the context of the thesis. 3. Role of the quote in the larger context of a book. 4. Historical/Philosophical background of the quote. After the presentation, 5. the instructor will ask challenging follow-up questions about the quote and the book as a whole, and the student has to prepare to defend their position and interpretation. 6. The presentation has to be delivered according to the high standards of public speaking: no repetitions, confident voice, no filler words, appropriate cadence and rhythm. 10 points available for satisfying each item. 60-points maximum.

Class Policies (attendance & devices)

Attendance in all classes is mandatory; after two unexcused absences, the student is at risk of failing the class. Phone, laptop, tablet, and any electronic device use in class is strictly prohibited unless specified otherwise by the instructor. If you are caught using a phone during class two times, you might fail the class. You must bring a physical copy of the book we discuss that week. If you don't have the book with you more than two times, you might fail the class. You don't have to print texts that are uploaded on Brightspace. Use of AI in any shape or form is strictly prohibited

Full Syllabus Extract

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